

## Beta time

The third beta version of Opera 10 is now available online – this focuses on a more stable and faster performing solution

## Android creates Magic

The HTC Magic running Android OS has sold over a million units, according to a statement made by HTC CEO Peter Chou

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The internet has developed to the point where many web sites are thought of more as applications, with browsers designed such that you launch applications from your desktop that are actually services running in a window.

One persistent problem with browsers has been that many have been plagued by bugs and security vulnerabilities. It seems that the more popular a browser gets, the more holes are discovered, often causing users to move from one browser to another. On the other hand, browser developers compete with each other by adding more and more features into their browser, turning some of them almost into bloatware, stuffed with features simply not needed by most users.

But if you have had enough of the bloatware and security vulnerabilities in your browser, you might not be aware of the scope available to you for change – there are more browsers out there than you think. Each of these browsers uses the rendering backend, or engine, that is used by the

popular browsers Firefox and Safari. They are therefore perfect for browsing, but each has been developed for different kinds of users, some of whom may want a large number of features, others, something as light as possible. Here, we introduce you to some of the alternatives, both for desktops and mobiles.

## K-Meleon

If you need a lightweight Firefox-like browser

Web site: <http://kmeleon.sourceforge.net>

Latest version: 1.5.3

Renderer: Gecko

Download size: Approx 5 MB

The open source browser K-Meleon has had a small, but loyal following since it was launched back in 2000. At that time, it lacked many important features, but nine years down the line and it has caught up with the competition. Today, it's a robust and usable all-purpose browser, suitable for most users. It is also light on resources and consumes only around 12 MB of RAM while running with one tab open.

One of the better-known browsers, Opera, is liked by many simply because fact you get the complete package all in one go. Firefox, on the other hand, does require some degree of customisation in terms of



K-Meleon is a hearty competitor as an alternative browser

plug-ins and add-ons to get it up to speed. The K-Meleon browser is more like Opera, in that it comes most goodies built-in. It is feature-packed, but also has support for add-ons.

A built-in ad blocker, mouse gestures and a news feed reader are just some of the features that come with K-Meleon, so clearly you won't be missing out on anything major. One feature that speeds up the load time of K-Meleon is a loader application that sits in your system tray. Double-clicking it opens the browser within a second on almost any

# Browser Alternatives

We've taken a look at the other browsers out there and have found out some interesting browsers that will catch your fancy